

General Knowledge

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STUDY NOTES

The Nobel Awards

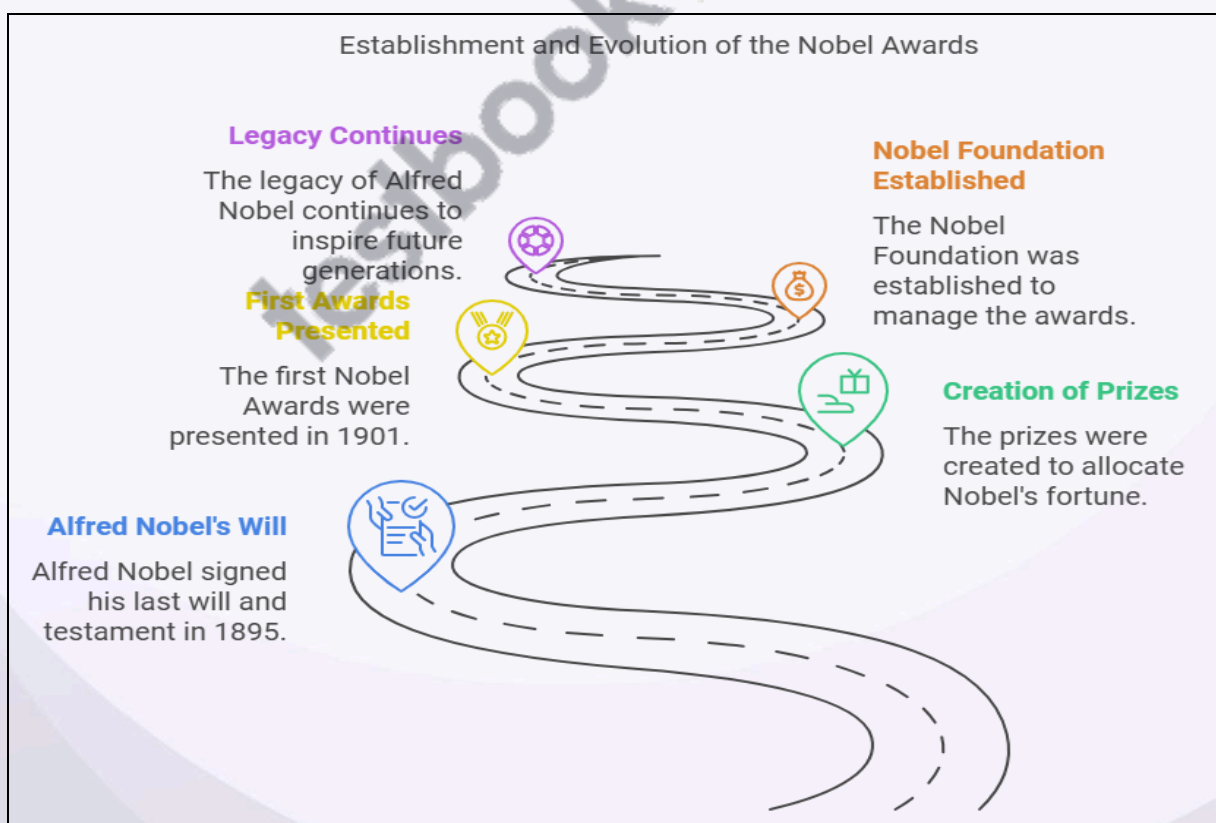


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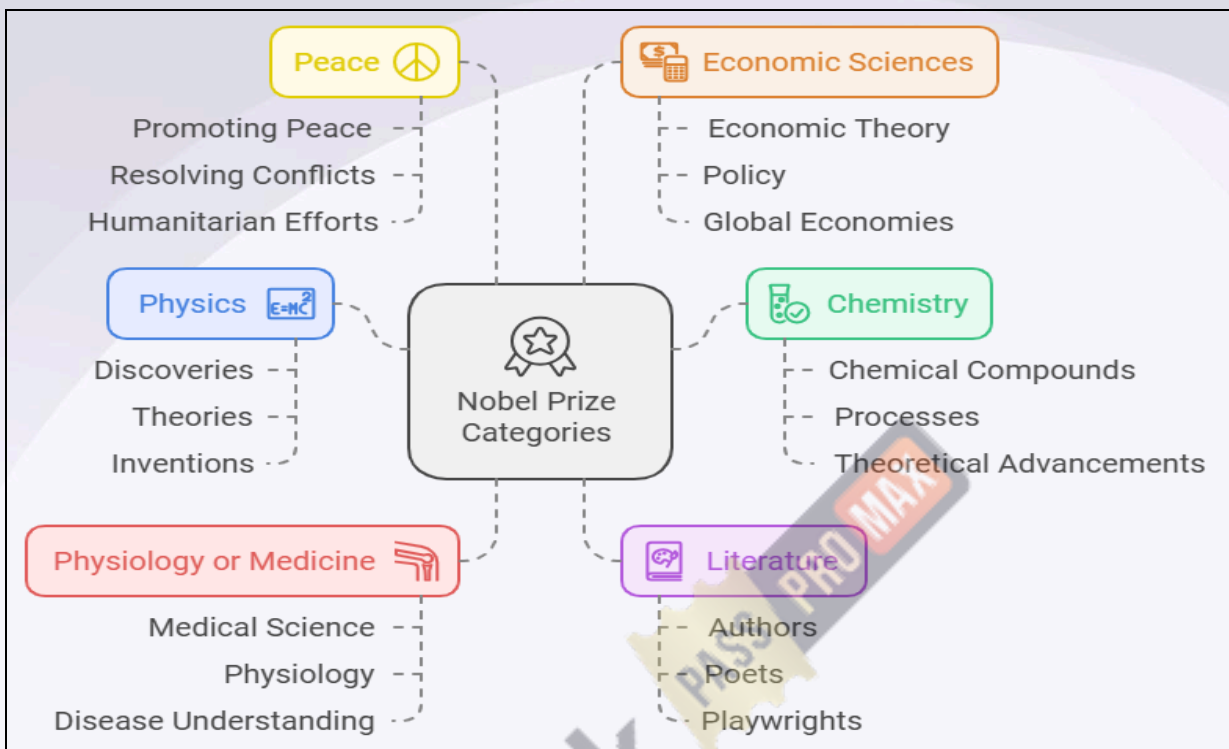
The Nobel Prize, one of the most prestigious accolades globally, recognizes individuals and organizations who have made significant contributions in the **fields of Physics, Chemistry, Physiology or Medicine, Literature, Peace, and Economic Sciences**. It reflects humanity's pursuit of knowledge, innovation, and social progress.

History of the Nobel Prize

- The Nobel Prize is a prestigious international award that traces its origins to the will of Alfred Nobel, a Swedish chemist, engineer, and inventor, renowned for inventing dynamite.
- On **November 27, 1895**, Nobel signed his will at the **Swedish-Norwegian Club in Paris**, dedicating the majority of his fortune to establishing prizes that would recognize exceptional contributions in specified fields.



Categories of the Nobel Awards



Selection Process for Nobel Laureates

Nomination Process

- **Who can nominate?**
 - Only certain individuals or groups are eligible to submit nominations. This includes:
 - Previous Nobel Laureates.
 - Members of Nobel Committees.
 - Academics from certain universities and research institutions.
 - Other experts are specifically invited by the Nobel Committees.
- **Self-nominations are not allowed.**
- **Timeline:**
 - Invitations for nominations are sent out in **September** of the preceding year.
 - Nominations must be submitted by **January 31** of the award year.
- **Announcement of Laureates**

- The Nobel laureates are announced in **October**, and the awards are presented on **December 10**, the death anniversary of Alfred Nobel

Significant Nobel Laureates

Name	Field	Achievements	Impact
Marie Curie	Physics (1903), Chemistry (1911)	First woman to win a Nobel Prize; discovery of radioactivity, radium, and polonium.	Pioneered radiation research; inspired cancer treatments; broke barriers for women in science.
Malala Yousafzai	Peace (2014)	Youngest Nobel laureate at 17; advocate for girls' education; survived Taliban assassination attempt.	Inspired education rights movements; established the Malala Fund.
Albert Einstein	Physics (1921)	Discovery of the photoelectric effect; foundational to quantum theory.	Revolutionized physics with relativity and quantum mechanics; inspired generations of scientists.
Martin Luther King Jr.	Peace (1964)	Leadership in the Civil Rights Movement; advocated nonviolent protest and racial equality.	Instrumental in passing the Civil Rights Act and Voting Rights Act; a symbol of justice and equality.
Mother Teresa	Peace (1979)	Humanitarian work with the poor and sick via the Missionaries of Charity.	Inspired global compassion and service; championed dignity for marginalized communities.

Amartya Sen	Economic Sciences (1998)	Work in welfare economics and the Capability Approach; emphasized human development over GDP.	Shaped global development policies; influenced UN frameworks like HDI.
Nelson Mandela	Peace (1993)	Efforts to dismantle apartheid in South Africa; shared prize with F.W. de Klerk.	Symbol of reconciliation and unity; championed human rights and social justice globally.
Jean-Paul Sartre	Literature (1964)	Contributions to existential philosophy and literature; works include Being and Nothingness and Nausea.	Refused the Nobel Prize; highlighted the autonomy of art; influenced modern philosophy and existential thought.
William G. Kaelin Jr., Sir Peter J. Ratcliffe, and Gregg L. Semenza	Physiology or Medicine (2019)	Discovery of how cells sense and adapt to oxygen availability.	Advanced treatments for anaemia, cancer, and other diseases.

Nobel Memorial Prize winners from India (including British Indian Citizens and Indian Citizens)

Year	Name	Family	Field	Reason
1913	Rabindranath Tagore	Bengali Hindu Brahmin family, Khulna, Bengal (now Bangladesh)	Literature	Gitanjali (A collection of poems)

1930	Sir Chandrasekhara Venkata Raman	Tamil Hindu Brahmin family, Thanjavur, Madras Presidency (now Tamil Nadu)	Physics	Discovery of Raman Effect (scattering of light)
2014	Kailash Satyarthi	Hindustani (Hindi) Hindu Brahmin family, Vidisha, Madhya Bharat State (now Madhya Pradesh)	Peace	For his struggle against child labour and promoting education for children

Overseas citizens of Indian origin

Year	Laureate	Country of Residence	Field	Rationale
1968	Har Gobind Khorana	United States (born in Raipur, Punjab, British India, now Pakistan))	Physiology or Medicine	For their interpretation of the genetic code and its function in protein synthesis.
1983	Subrahmanyam Chandrasekhar	United States (born in Lahore, Punjab, British India, now Pakistan))	Physics	For his theoretical studies of the physical processes of importance to the structure and evolution of the stars.
2009	Venkatraman Ramakrishnan	United Kingdom / United States	Chemistry	For studies of the structure and function of the ribosome.

		(born in Chidambaram, India)		
2019	Abhijit Banerjee	United States (born in Mumbai, India)	Economics	For his experimental approach to alleviating global poverty.

Nobel laureates with Indian linkages – foreigners who were born in India

Year	Laureate	Country of Residence	Field	Rationale
1902	Ronald Ross	United Kingdom ((born in Almora, British India)	Physiology or Medicine	For his work on malaria, showing how it enters the organism and laying the foundation for research on combating it.
1907	Rudyard Kipling	United Kingdom (born in Bombay, British India)	Literature	For his power of observation, originality, and remarkable narrative talent.
1989	14th Dalai Lama	India	Peace	For his consistent resistance to violence in the struggle for liberty.
2001	V. S. Naipaul	United Kingdom	Literature	For his perceptive narrative and incorruptible scrutiny of suppressed histories.

Nobel Prize winners from 2022 to 2024:

Year	Category	Laureate(s)	Country	Contribution
2024	Physics	John J. Hopfield, Geoffrey E. Hinton	USA, UK	For foundational discoveries and inventions enabling machine learning with artificial neural networks.
	Chemistry	David Baker, Demis Hassabis, John Jumper	USA, UK	For computational protein design and AI models predicting protein structures.
	Physiology or Medicine	Victor Ambros, Gary Ruvkun	USA	For the discovery of microRNA and its role in gene regulation.
	Literature	Han Kang	South Korea	For intense poetic prose confronting historical traumas and exposing human fragility.
	Peace	Nihon Hidankyo	Japan	For efforts to achieve a world free of nuclear weapons and highlighting testimonies of atomic bomb survivors.
	Economic Sciences	Daron Acemoglu, Simon Johnson, James A. Robinson	USA	For studies on how institutions are formed and affect prosperity.
2023	Physics	Pierre Agostini, Ferenc Krausz, Anne L'Huillier	France, Hungary, Sweden	For experimental methods generating attosecond pulses of light for studying electron dynamics in matter.

	Chemistry	Moungi Bawendi, Louis Brus, Aleksey Yekimov	USA, Russia	For the discovery and synthesis of quantum dots.
	Physiology or Medicine	Katalin Karikó, Drew Weissman	Hungary, USA	For discoveries enabling effective mRNA vaccines against COVID-19.
	Literature	Jon Fosse	Norway	For innovative plays and prose giving voice to the unsayable.
	Peace	Narges Mohammadi	Iran	For fighting against the oppression of women in Iran and promoting human rights and freedom.
	Economic Sciences	Claudia Goldin	USA	For advancing understanding of women's labor market outcomes.
2022	Physics	Alain Aspect, John F. Clauser, Anton Zeilinger	France, USA, Austria	For experiments with entangled photons, establishing the violation of Bell inequalities, and pioneering quantum information science.
	Chemistry	Carolyn R. Bertozzi, Morten Meldal, K. Barry Sharpless	USA, Denmark, USA	For the development of click chemistry and bioorthogonal chemistry.
	Physiology or Medicine	Svante Pääbo	Sweden	For discoveries concerning the genomes of extinct hominins and human evolution.
	Literature	Annie Ernaux	France	For uncovering the roots, estrangements, and collective restraints of personal memory.

	Peace	Ales Bialiatski, Memorial, Center for Civil Liberties	Belarus, Russia, Ukraine	For documenting war crimes, human rights abuses, and abuse of power.
	Economic Sciences	Ben S. Bernanke, Douglas W. Diamond, Philip H. Dybvig	USA	For research on banks and financial crises.